

SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Lok Adalats and Other Courts - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Lok Adalats and Other Courts - Complete Uncompressed Learning Session

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Original MCQs 1-36 - Broad Coverage

OM1. Which statement most accurately describes Article 39A?

- A. It abolishes court fees.
- B. It is a Fundamental Right text.
- C. It directs equal-opportunity justice and free legal aid.
- D. It creates every Lok Adalat directly.

Answer: C

Explanation: Statutes and Article 21 doctrine operationalise the directive. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM2. Which statement most accurately describes authority ladder?

- A. NALSA is a trial court.
- B. Only income-based persons qualify.
- C. The 1987 Act links NALSA, State, High Court, District and Taluk bodies.
- D. DLSA is constitutional.

Answer: C

Explanation: The ladder combines policy and delivery. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM3. Which statement most accurately describes ordinary Lok Adalat?

- A. It is an arbitral tribunal.
- B. It settles pending or pre-litigation disputes only through compromise.
- C. It hears non-compoundable offences.
- D. It always decides merits.

Answer: B

Explanation: Consent is the source of the award. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM4. Which statement most accurately describes failed settlement?

- A. PLA rules automatically apply.
- B. The Lok Adalat imposes judgment.
- C. A pending case returns to court when ordinary Lok Adalat settlement fails.
- D. The claim is extinguished.

Answer: C

Explanation: No compromise means no ordinary award. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM5. Which statement most accurately describes award effect?

- A. It requires arbitral enforcement.
- B. A compromise award is final, binding and deemed a civil-court decree with no statutory appeal.
- C. It is merely advice.
- D. No review is conceivable.

Answer: B

Explanation: Limited constitutional challenge survives fraud/consent/jurisdiction defects. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM6. Which statement most accurately describes Permanent Lok Adalat?

- A. PLA is pre-litigation, public-utility specific and conciliates before eligible merits adjudication.
- B. It hears every civil dispute.
- C. Consent is always required for the final merits award.
- D. It is an ordinary permanent sitting.

Answer: A

Explanation: Its hybrid power is statutory and limited. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM7. Which statement most accurately describes operational forms?

- A. Each is a new constitutional court.
- B. National, Mega, Mobile and E-Lok Adalats do not change the underlying legal character.
- C. E-Lok Adalat can compel settlement.
- D. Mobile format creates appeal.

Answer: B

Explanation: Format is not jurisdiction. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM8. Which statement most accurately describes Gram Nyayalaya?

- A. It has no adjudicatory power.
- B. It is a Lok Adalat.
- C. It is a statutory local/mobile first-instance court with scheduled jurisdiction and appeals.
- D. It is a Panchayat.

Answer: C

Explanation: Establishment and utilisation remain State-dependent. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM9. Which statement most accurately describes Family Court?

- A. It is a statutory court combining family adjudication with settlement orientation.
- B. Lawyers always have an absolute right of appearance.
- C. It is a tribunal under Article 323B.
- D. It is compromise-only.

Answer: A

Explanation: Specialisation does not remove fairness or appeal rules. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM10. Which statement most accurately describes other courts?

- A. Every label creates a constitutional level.
- B. All have identical appeals.
- C. All are ADR.
- D. Fast Track/evening courts are designs; special/commercial courts depend on governing law.

Answer: D

Explanation: Source determines power. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM11. Which statement most accurately describes mediation?

- A. Every mediation is Lok Adalat.
- B. Mediation produces a party-made settlement and differs from PLA merits adjudication.
- C. Mediator imposes a decree.
- D. The 2023 Act erases sectoral laws.

Answer: B

Explanation: Check commencement, rules and exclusions. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM12. Which statement most accurately describes fairness?

- A. Disposal volume alone proves justice.
- B. Online access has no exclusion risk.
- C. Finality cures coercion.
- D. Access gains must be tested against consent quality, power asymmetry and digital exclusion.

Answer: D

Explanation: Access requires affordability and procedural fairness. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM13. Which is the safest UPSC distinction concerning Article 39A?

- A. It creates every Lok Adalat directly.
- B. It is a Fundamental Right text.
- C. It directs equal-opportunity justice and free legal aid.
- D. It abolishes court fees.

Answer: C

Explanation: Statutes and Article 21 doctrine operationalise the directive. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM14. Which is the safest UPSC distinction concerning authority ladder?

- A. Only income-based persons qualify.
- B. The 1987 Act links NALSA, State, High Court, District and Taluk bodies.
- C. NALSA is a trial court.
- D. DLSA is constitutional.

Answer: B

Explanation: The ladder combines policy and delivery. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM15. Which is the safest UPSC distinction concerning ordinary Lok Adalat?

- A. It is an arbitral tribunal.
- B. It settles pending or pre-litigation disputes only through compromise.
- C. It hears non-compoundable offences.
- D. It always decides merits.

Answer: B

Explanation: Consent is the source of the award. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM16. Which is the safest UPSC distinction concerning failed settlement?

- A. The claim is extinguished.
- B. The Lok Adalat imposes judgment.
- C. PLA rules automatically apply.

- D. A pending case returns to court when ordinary Lok Adalat settlement fails.

Answer: D

Explanation: No compromise means no ordinary award. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM17. Which is the safest UPSC distinction concerning award effect?

- A. No review is conceivable.
- B. It is merely advice.
- C. It requires arbitral enforcement.
- D. A compromise award is final, binding and deemed a civil-court decree with no statutory appeal.

Answer: D

Explanation: Limited constitutional challenge survives fraud/consent/jurisdiction defects. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM18. Which is the safest UPSC distinction concerning Permanent Lok Adalat?

- A. It is an ordinary permanent sitting.
- B. PLA is pre-litigation, public-utility specific and conciliates before eligible merits adjudication.
- C. Consent is always required for the final merits award.
- D. It hears every civil dispute.

Answer: B

Explanation: Its hybrid power is statutory and limited. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM19. Which is the safest UPSC distinction concerning operational forms?

- A. Each is a new constitutional court.
- B. E-Lok Adalat can compel settlement.
- C. Mobile format creates appeal.
- D. National, Mega, Mobile and E-Lok Adalats do not change the underlying legal character.

Answer: D

Explanation: Format is not jurisdiction. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM20. Which is the safest UPSC distinction concerning Gram Nyayalaya?

- A. It has no adjudicatory power.
- B. It is a statutory local/mobile first-instance court with scheduled jurisdiction and appeals.
- C. It is a Panchayat.
- D. It is a Lok Adalat.

Answer: B

Explanation: Establishment and utilisation remain State-dependent. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM21. Which is the safest UPSC distinction concerning Family Court?

- A. It is a statutory court combining family adjudication with settlement orientation.
- B. It is compromise-only.
- C. It is a tribunal under Article 323B.
- D. Lawyers always have an absolute right of appearance.

Answer: A

Explanation: Specialisation does not remove fairness or appeal rules. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM22. Which is the safest UPSC distinction concerning other courts?

- A. Fast Track/evening courts are designs; special/commercial courts depend on governing law.
- B. All are ADR.
- C. Every label creates a constitutional level.
- D. All have identical appeals.

Answer: A

Explanation: Source determines power. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM23. Which is the safest UPSC distinction concerning mediation?

- A. The 2023 Act erases sectoral laws.
- B. Mediation produces a party-made settlement and differs from PLA merits adjudication.
- C. Mediator imposes a decree.
- D. Every mediation is Lok Adalat.

Answer: B

Explanation: Check commencement, rules and exclusions. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM24. Which is the safest UPSC distinction concerning fairness?

- A. Disposal volume alone proves justice.
- B. Finality cures coercion.
- C. Access gains must be tested against consent quality, power asymmetry and digital exclusion.
- D. Online access has no exclusion risk.

Answer: C

Explanation: Access requires affordability and procedural fairness. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM25. A candidate makes a close-option error about Article 39A. Which correction is most accurate?

- A. It directs equal-opportunity justice and free legal aid.
- B. It is a Fundamental Right text.
- C. It creates every Lok Adalat directly.
- D. It abolishes court fees.

Answer: A

Explanation: Statutes and Article 21 doctrine operationalise the directive. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM26. A candidate makes a close-option error about authority ladder. Which correction is most accurate?

- A. NALSA is a trial court.
- B. Only income-based persons qualify.
- C. DLSA is constitutional.
- D. The 1987 Act links NALSA, State, High Court, District and Taluk bodies.

Answer: D

Explanation: The ladder combines policy and delivery. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM27. A candidate makes a close-option error about ordinary Lok Adalat. Which correction is most accurate?

- A. It settles pending or pre-litigation disputes only through compromise.
- B. It is an arbitral tribunal.

- C. It hears non-compoundable offences.
- D. It always decides merits.

Answer: A

Explanation: Consent is the source of the award. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM28. A candidate makes a close-option error about failed settlement. Which correction is most accurate?

- A. The claim is extinguished.
- B. A pending case returns to court when ordinary Lok Adalat settlement fails.
- C. PLA rules automatically apply.
- D. The Lok Adalat imposes judgment.

Answer: B

Explanation: No compromise means no ordinary award. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM29. A candidate makes a close-option error about award effect. Which correction is most accurate?

- A. No review is conceivable.
- B. It requires arbitral enforcement.
- C. It is merely advice.
- D. A compromise award is final, binding and deemed a civil-court decree with no statutory appeal.

Answer: D

Explanation: Limited constitutional challenge survives fraud/consent/jurisdiction defects. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM30. A candidate makes a close-option error about Permanent Lok Adalat. Which correction is most accurate?

- A. Consent is always required for the final merits award.
- B. It hears every civil dispute.
- C. PLA is pre-litigation, public-utility specific and conciliates before eligible merits adjudication.
- D. It is an ordinary permanent sitting.

Answer: C

Explanation: Its hybrid power is statutory and limited. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM31. A candidate makes a close-option error about operational forms. Which correction is most accurate?

- A. E-Lok Adalat can compel settlement.
- B. Mobile format creates appeal.
- C. National, Mega, Mobile and E-Lok Adalats do not change the underlying legal character.
- D. Each is a new constitutional court.

Answer: C

Explanation: Format is not jurisdiction. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM32. A candidate makes a close-option error about Gram Nyayalaya. Which correction is most accurate?

- A. It is a Panchayat.
- B. It is a statutory local/mobile first-instance court with scheduled jurisdiction and appeals.
- C. It is a Lok Adalat.
- D. It has no adjudicatory power.

Answer: B

Explanation: Establishment and utilisation remain State-dependent. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM33. A candidate makes a close-option error about Family Court. Which correction is most accurate?

- A. It is compromise-only.
- B. Lawyers always have an absolute right of appearance.
- C. It is a statutory court combining family adjudication with settlement orientation.
- D. It is a tribunal under Article 323B.

Answer: C

Explanation: Specialisation does not remove fairness or appeal rules. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM34. A candidate makes a close-option error about other courts. Which correction is most accurate?

- A. Fast Track/evening courts are designs; special/commercial courts depend on governing law.
- B. All have identical appeals.
- C. All are ADR.
- D. Every label creates a constitutional level.

Answer: A

Explanation: Source determines power. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM35. A candidate makes a close-option error about mediation. Which correction is most accurate?

- A. Every mediation is Lok Adalat.
- B. Mediation produces a party-made settlement and differs from PLA merits adjudication.
- C. Mediator imposes a decree.
- D. The 2023 Act erases sectoral laws.

Answer: B

Explanation: Check commencement, rules and exclusions. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

OM36. A candidate makes a close-option error about fairness. Which correction is most accurate?

- A. Online access has no exclusion risk.
- B. Disposal volume alone proves justice.
- C. Finality cures coercion.
- D. Access gains must be tested against consent quality, power asymmetry and digital exclusion.

Answer: D

Explanation: Access requires affordability and procedural fairness. The other options collapse distinct legal sources, institutions or consequences and therefore fail the close-option test.

Remedial MCQs 1-12 - Common Error Repair

RM1. Which statement best repairs a recurring error about Article 39A?

- A. It directs equal-opportunity justice and free legal aid.
- B. It creates every Lok Adalat directly.
- C. It abolishes court fees.
- D. It is a Fundamental Right text.

Answer: A

Remedial explanation: Statutes and Article 21 doctrine operationalise the directive. Write the governing source, then the mechanism, and finally the limitation before choosing an option.

RM2. Which statement best repairs a recurring error about authority ladder?

- A. DLSA is constitutional.
- B. Only income-based persons qualify.
- C. The 1987 Act links NALSA, State, High Court, District and Taluk bodies.
- D. NALSA is a trial court.

Answer: C

Remedial explanation: The ladder combines policy and delivery. Write the governing source, then the mechanism, and finally the limitation before choosing an option.

RM3. Which statement best repairs a recurring error about ordinary Lok Adalat?

- A. It hears non-compoundable offences.
- B. It always decides merits.
- C. It is an arbitral tribunal.
- D. It settles pending or pre-litigation disputes only through compromise.

Answer: D

Remedial explanation: Consent is the source of the award. Write the governing source, then the mechanism, and finally the limitation before choosing an option.

RM4. Which statement best repairs a recurring error about failed settlement?

- A. A pending case returns to court when ordinary Lok Adalat settlement fails.
- B. The Lok Adalat imposes judgment.
- C. PLA rules automatically apply.
- D. The claim is extinguished.

Answer: A

Remedial explanation: No compromise means no ordinary award. Write the governing source, then the mechanism, and finally the limitation before choosing an option.

RM5. Which statement best repairs a recurring error about award effect?

- A. No review is conceivable.
- B. It is merely advice.
- C. It requires arbitral enforcement.
- D. A compromise award is final, binding and deemed a civil-court decree with no statutory appeal.

Answer: D

Remedial explanation: Limited constitutional challenge survives fraud/consent/jurisdiction defects. Write the governing source, then the mechanism, and finally the limitation before choosing an option.

RM6. Which statement best repairs a recurring error about Permanent Lok Adalat?

- A. It is an ordinary permanent sitting.
- B. Consent is always required for the final merits award.
- C. It hears every civil dispute.
- D. PLA is pre-litigation, public-utility specific and conciliates before eligible merits adjudication.

Answer: D

Remedial explanation: Its hybrid power is statutory and limited. Write the governing source, then the mechanism, and finally the limitation before choosing an option.

RM7. Which statement best repairs a recurring error about operational forms?

- A. E-Lok Adalat can compel settlement.

- B. Each is a new constitutional court.
- C. National, Mega, Mobile and E-Lok Adalats do not change the underlying legal character.
- D. Mobile format creates appeal.

Answer: C

Remedial explanation: Format is not jurisdiction. Write the governing source, then the mechanism, and finally the limitation before choosing an option.

RM8. Which statement best repairs a recurring error about Gram Nyayalaya?

- A. It is a statutory local/mobile first-instance court with scheduled jurisdiction and appeals.
- B. It is a Panchayat.
- C. It has no adjudicatory power.
- D. It is a Lok Adalat.

Answer: A

Remedial explanation: Establishment and utilisation remain State-dependent. Write the governing source, then the mechanism, and finally the limitation before choosing an option.

RM9. Which statement best repairs a recurring error about Family Court?

- A. It is compromise-only.
- B. Lawyers always have an absolute right of appearance.
- C. It is a tribunal under Article 323B.
- D. It is a statutory court combining family adjudication with settlement orientation.

Answer: D

Remedial explanation: Specialisation does not remove fairness or appeal rules. Write the governing source, then the mechanism, and finally the limitation before choosing an option.

RM10. Which statement best repairs a recurring error about other courts?

- A. Fast Track/evening courts are designs; special/commercial courts depend on governing law.
- B. All are ADR.
- C. All have identical appeals.
- D. Every label creates a constitutional level.

Answer: A

Remedial explanation: Source determines power. Write the governing source, then the mechanism, and finally the limitation before choosing an option.

RM11. Which statement best repairs a recurring error about mediation?

- A. Every mediation is Lok Adalat.
- B. The 2023 Act erases sectoral laws.
- C. Mediation produces a party-made settlement and differs from PLA merits adjudication.
- D. Mediator imposes a decree.

Answer: C

Remedial explanation: Check commencement, rules and exclusions. Write the governing source, then the mechanism, and finally the limitation before choosing an option.

RM12. Which statement best repairs a recurring error about fairness?

- A. Access gains must be tested against consent quality, power asymmetry and digital exclusion.
- B. Disposal volume alone proves justice.
- C. Online access has no exclusion risk.
- D. Finality cures coercion.

Answer: A

Remedial explanation: Access requires affordability and procedural fairness. Write the governing source, then the mechanism, and finally the limitation before choosing an option.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Verified and Supporting PYQs with Model Solutions

Verified direct PYQ 1 - 2020 Prelims GS-I Q9

Question: Evaluate eligibility categories for free legal services under the Legal Services Authorities framework.

Directive: Objective statement evaluation · **Marks:** 2 · **Word limit:** objective

Model solution

Opening: Evaluate eligibility categories for free legal services under the Legal Services Authorities framework. The answer must respond to the directive **Objective statement evaluation** rather than merely describe the topic.

- **Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** Section 12 contains status-based and income-based categories.
- **Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** SC/ST members, women/children, custody and specified vulnerability may qualify.
- **Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** Free legal services are broader than criminal-trial representation.
- **Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** The authority also considers whether a prima facie case exists.

Conclusion: The strongest answer identifies the governing design, shows how it operates with named evidence, tests the counter-position and ends with a qualified institutional verdict.

Verified direct PYQ 2 - 2023 GS-II Q2

Question: Assess entitlement to free legal aid and the role of NALSA.

Directive: Assess · **Marks:** 10 · **Word limit:** 150

Model solution

Opening: Assess entitlement to free legal aid and the role of NALSA. The answer must respond to the directive **Assess** rather than merely describe the topic.

- **Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** Article 39A supplies the constitutional access-to-justice anchor.
- **Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** NALSA sets policy and schemes under the 1987 Act.
- **Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** State, District and Taluk institutions deliver legal services.
- **Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** Hussainara Khatoon (1979) links legal aid and speed to fair procedure.
- **Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** Quality, awareness and continuity qualify formal entitlement.

Conclusion: The strongest answer identifies the governing design, shows how it operates with named evidence, tests the counter-position and ends with a qualified institutional verdict.

Verified direct PYQ 3 - 2024 GS-II Q2

Question: Explain and distinguish Lok Adalats and Arbitration Tribunals.

Directive: Explain and distinguish · **Marks:** 10 · **Word limit:** 150

Model solution

Opening: Explain and distinguish Lok Adalats and Arbitration Tribunals. The answer must respond to the directive **Explain and distinguish** rather than merely describe the topic.

- **Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** Ordinary Lok Adalat is statutory compromise-based settlement.
- **Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** An arbitral tribunal derives adjudicatory authority from agreement and statute.
- **Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** Lok Adalat award is a deemed decree; arbitral award follows the arbitration enforcement route.

- **Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** Ordinary Lok Adalat cannot impose a merits result after settlement fails.
- **Claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** PLA is a separate public-utility hybrid and must not be used to define every Lok Adalat.

Conclusion: The strongest answer identifies the governing design, shows how it operates with named evidence, tests the counter-position and ends with a qualified institutional verdict.

Original Solved Mains Practice

M1. Distinguish an ordinary Lok Adalat from a Permanent Lok Adalat.

Directive: Distinguish · **Marks:** 10 · **Suggested words:** 150

Demand decode: Define the exact institutional or doctrinal issue, answer the directive, use named constitutional/statutory/judicial evidence, include the strongest counterpoint and reach a qualified verdict.

Examiner opening: Distinguish an ordinary Lok Adalat from a Permanent Lok Adalat. The issue should be analysed through constitutional purpose, operating mechanism and enforceable limitation.

- **Authority Ladder - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** The 1987 Act links NALSA, State, High Court, District and Taluk bodies. The ladder combines policy and delivery.
- **Ordinary Lok Adalat - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** It settles pending or pre-litigation disputes only through compromise. Consent is the source of the award.
- **Failed Settlement - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** A pending case returns to court when ordinary Lok Adalat settlement fails. No compromise means no ordinary award.
- **Award Effect - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** A compromise award is final, binding and deemed a civil-court decree with no statutory appeal. Limited constitutional challenge survives fraud/consent/jurisdiction defects.
- **Permanent Lok Adalat - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** PLA is pre-litigation, public-utility specific and conciliates before eligible merits adjudication. Its hybrid power is statutory and limited.

Counter-position: Institutional reform can improve accountability, but overbroad regulation may displace autonomy, federal choice, expertise or access. The answer must identify the exact trade-off rather than offer a generic reform list.

Conclusion: Prefer a calibrated design that preserves the institution's constitutional purpose while adding transparency, independence, reason-giving and judicially reviewable safeguards.

M2. Explain the constitutional and statutory basis of free legal aid.

Directive: Explain · **Marks:** 10 · **Suggested words:** 150

Demand decode: Define the exact institutional or doctrinal issue, answer the directive, use named constitutional/statutory/judicial evidence, include the strongest counterpoint and reach a qualified verdict.

Examiner opening: Explain the constitutional and statutory basis of free legal aid. The issue should be analysed through constitutional purpose, operating mechanism and enforceable limitation.

- **Ordinary Lok Adalat - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** It settles pending or pre-litigation disputes only through compromise. Consent is the source of the award.
- **Failed Settlement - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** A pending case returns to court when ordinary Lok Adalat settlement fails. No compromise means no ordinary award.
- **Award Effect - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** A compromise award is final, binding and deemed a civil-court decree with no statutory appeal. Limited constitutional challenge survives fraud/consent/jurisdiction defects.
- **Permanent Lok Adalat - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** PLA is pre-litigation, public-utility specific and conciliates before eligible merits adjudication. Its hybrid power is statutory and limited.
- **Operational Forms - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** National, Mega, Mobile and E-Lok Adalats do not change the underlying legal character. Format is not jurisdiction.

Counter-position: Institutional reform can improve accountability, but overbroad regulation may displace autonomy, federal choice, expertise or access. The answer must identify the exact trade-off rather than offer a generic reform list.

Conclusion: Prefer a calibrated design that preserves the institution's constitutional purpose while adding transparency, independence, reason-giving and judicially reviewable safeguards.

M3. Assess Gram Nyayalayas as instruments of doorstep justice.

Directive: Assess · **Marks:** 15 · **Suggested words:** 250

Demand decode: Define the exact institutional or doctrinal issue, answer the directive, use named constitutional/statutory/judicial evidence, include the strongest counterpoint and reach a qualified verdict.

Examiner opening: Assess Gram Nyayalayas as instruments of doorstep justice. The issue should be analysed through constitutional purpose, operating mechanism and enforceable limitation.

- **Failed Settlement - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** A pending case returns to court when ordinary Lok Adalat settlement fails. No compromise means no ordinary award.
- **Award Effect - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** A compromise award is final, binding and deemed a civil-court decree with no statutory appeal. Limited constitutional challenge survives fraud/consent/jurisdiction defects.
- **Permanent Lok Adalat - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** PLA is pre-litigation, public-utility specific and conciliates before eligible merits adjudication. Its hybrid power is statutory and limited.
- **Operational Forms - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** National, Mega, Mobile and E-Lok Adalats do not change the underlying legal character. Format is not jurisdiction.
- **Gram Nyayalaya - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** It is a statutory local/mobile first-instance court with scheduled jurisdiction and appeals. Establishment and utilisation remain State-dependent.

Counter-position: Institutional reform can improve accountability, but overbroad regulation may displace autonomy, federal choice, expertise or access. The answer must identify the exact trade-off rather than offer a generic reform list.

Conclusion: Prefer a calibrated design that preserves the institution's constitutional purpose while adding transparency, independence, reason-giving and judicially reviewable safeguards.

M4. Compare Family Courts, Commercial Courts and Fast Track Courts.

Directive: Compare · **Marks:** 15 · **Suggested words:** 250

Demand decode: Define the exact institutional or doctrinal issue, answer the directive, use named constitutional/statutory/judicial evidence, include the strongest counterpoint and reach a qualified verdict.

Examiner opening: Compare Family Courts, Commercial Courts and Fast Track Courts. The issue should be analysed through constitutional purpose, operating mechanism and enforceable limitation.

- **Award Effect - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** A compromise award is final, binding and deemed a civil-court decree with no statutory appeal. Limited constitutional challenge survives fraud/consent/jurisdiction defects.
- **Permanent Lok Adalat - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** PLA is pre-litigation, public-utility specific and conciliates before eligible merits adjudication. Its hybrid power is statutory and limited.
- **Operational Forms - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** National, Mega, Mobile and E-Lok Adalats do not change the underlying legal character. Format is not jurisdiction.
- **Gram Nyayalaya - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** It is a statutory local/mobile first-instance court with scheduled jurisdiction and appeals. Establishment and utilisation remain State-dependent.
- **Family Court - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** It is a statutory court combining family adjudication with settlement orientation. Specialisation does not remove fairness or appeal rules.

Counter-position: Institutional reform can improve accountability, but overbroad regulation may displace autonomy, federal choice, expertise or access. The answer must identify the exact trade-off rather than offer a generic reform list.

Conclusion: Prefer a calibrated design that preserves the institution's constitutional purpose while adding transparency, independence, reason-giving and judicially reviewable safeguards.

M5. Analyse the Mediation Act 2023 interface with Lok Adalats and commercial justice.

Directive: Analyse · **Marks:** 15 · **Suggested words:** 250

Demand decode: Define the exact institutional or doctrinal issue, answer the directive, use named constitutional/statutory/judicial evidence, include the strongest counterpoint and reach a qualified verdict.

Examiner opening: Analyse the Mediation Act 2023 interface with Lok Adalats and commercial justice. The issue should be analysed through constitutional purpose, operating mechanism and enforceable limitation.

- **Permanent Lok Adalat - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** PLA is pre-litigation, public-utility specific and conciliates before eligible merits adjudication. Its hybrid power is statutory and limited.
- **Operational Forms - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** National, Mega, Mobile and E-Lok Adalats do not change the underlying legal character. Format is not jurisdiction.
- **Gram Nyayalaya - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** It is a statutory local/mobile first-instance court with scheduled jurisdiction and appeals. Establishment and utilisation remain State-dependent.
- **Family Court - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** It is a statutory court combining family adjudication with settlement orientation. Specialisation does not remove fairness or appeal rules.
- **Other Courts - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** Fast Track/evening courts are designs; special/commercial courts depend on governing law. Source determines power.

Counter-position: Institutional reform can improve accountability, but overbroad regulation may displace autonomy, federal choice, expertise or access. The answer must identify the exact trade-off rather than offer a generic reform list.

Conclusion: Prefer a calibrated design that preserves the institution's constitutional purpose while adding transparency, independence, reason-giving and judicially reviewable safeguards.

M6. Evaluate India's plural access-to-justice architecture.

Directive: Evaluate · **Marks:** 20 · **Suggested words:** 300

Demand decode: Define the exact institutional or doctrinal issue, answer the directive, use named constitutional/statutory/judicial evidence, include the strongest counterpoint and reach a qualified verdict.

Examiner opening: Evaluate India's plural access-to-justice architecture. The issue should be analysed through constitutional purpose, operating mechanism and enforceable limitation.

- **Operational Forms - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** National, Mega, Mobile and E-Lok Adalats do not change the underlying legal character. Format is not jurisdiction.
- **Gram Nyayalaya - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** It is a statutory local/mobile first-instance court with scheduled jurisdiction and appeals. Establishment and utilisation remain State-dependent.
- **Family Court - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** It is a statutory court combining family adjudication with settlement orientation. Specialisation does not remove fairness or appeal rules.
- **Other Courts - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** Fast Track/evening courts are designs; special/commercial courts depend on governing law. Source determines power.
- **Mediation - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** Mediation produces a party-made settlement and differs from PLA merits adjudication. Check commencement, rules and exclusions.

Counter-position: Institutional reform can improve accountability, but overbroad regulation may displace autonomy, federal choice, expertise or access. The answer must identify the exact trade-off rather than offer a generic reform list.

Conclusion: Prefer a calibrated design that preserves the institution's constitutional purpose while adding transparency, independence, reason-giving and judicially reviewable safeguards.

M7. Consent is the legitimacy boundary of settlement justice. Discuss.

Directive: Discuss · **Marks:** 20 · **Suggested words:** 300

Demand decode: Define the exact institutional or doctrinal issue, answer the directive, use named constitutional/statutory/judicial evidence, include the strongest counterpoint and reach a qualified verdict.

Examiner opening: Consent is the legitimacy boundary of settlement justice. Discuss. The issue should be analysed through constitutional purpose, operating mechanism and enforceable limitation.

- **Gram Nyayalaya - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** It is a statutory local/mobile first-instance court with scheduled jurisdiction and appeals. Establishment and utilisation remain State-dependent.

- **Family Court - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** It is a statutory court combining family adjudication with settlement orientation. Specialisation does not remove fairness or appeal rules.
- **Other Courts - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** Fast Track/evening courts are designs; special/commercial courts depend on governing law. Source determines power.
- **Mediation - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** Mediation produces a party-made settlement and differs from PLA merits adjudication. Check commencement, rules and exclusions.
- **Fairness - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** Access gains must be tested against consent quality, power asymmetry and digital exclusion. Access requires affordability and procedural fairness.

Counter-position: Institutional reform can improve accountability, but overbroad regulation may displace autonomy, federal choice, expertise or access. The answer must identify the exact trade-off rather than offer a generic reform list.

Conclusion: Prefer a calibrated design that preserves the institution's constitutional purpose while adding transparency, independence, reason-giving and judicially reviewable safeguards.

M8. Suggest reforms for accessible, fair and digitally inclusive dispute resolution.

Directive: Suggest · **Marks:** 20 · **Suggested words:** 300

Demand decode: Define the exact institutional or doctrinal issue, answer the directive, use named constitutional/statutory/judicial evidence, include the strongest counterpoint and reach a qualified verdict.

Examiner opening: Suggest reforms for accessible, fair and digitally inclusive dispute resolution. The issue should be analysed through constitutional purpose, operating mechanism and enforceable limitation.

- **Family Court - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** It is a statutory court combining family adjudication with settlement orientation. Specialisation does not remove fairness or appeal rules.
- **Other Courts - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** Fast Track/evening courts are designs; special/commercial courts depend on governing law. Source determines power.
- **Mediation - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** Mediation produces a party-made settlement and differs from PLA merits adjudication. Check commencement, rules and exclusions.
- **Fairness - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** Access gains must be tested against consent quality, power asymmetry and digital exclusion. Access requires affordability and procedural fairness.
- **Article 39A - claim -> evidence -> analysis -> qualification:** It directs equal-opportunity justice and free legal aid. Statutes and Article 21 doctrine operationalise the directive.

Counter-position: Institutional reform can improve accountability, but overbroad regulation may displace autonomy, federal choice, expertise or access. The answer must identify the exact trade-off rather than offer a generic reform list.

Conclusion: Prefer a calibrated design that preserves the institution's constitutional purpose while adding transparency, independence, reason-giving and judicially reviewable safeguards.